Ria Iyer

(669) 350-3091
riaiyer2@gmail.com

My portfolio can be found here: www.riaiyer.com

I am a product and interaction designer with a background in game design and HCI research. I design systems and complex interaction states, with enough front-end fluency to build what I design.

EXPERIENCE

Prelaunch Startup (stealth), Remote — *Product Designer*

JUNE 2026 - PRESENT

- Designed and implemented the product's visual design system, including dark & light modes, type scale, and responsive navigation
- Designing a conversational AI feature that spans three distinct user roles, working out per-role data scoping and permissions so that each user type has access to transactions appropriate to their role.

TeckKnowHow, San Jose — *Lead Instructor & Assistant*

JUNE 2025 - AUGUST 2025

- Taught weekly summer camps on game design and robotics.
- Gave presentations two to three times a day, guided learning activities, and communicated with parents regularly.
- Promoted from assistant to lead instructor mid-season.

TAPS, UCSC — *App Tester + Safe Ride Driver*

SEPTEMBER 2024 - JUNE 2025

- Gave detailed feedback on the app used for this service during the trial period and continued to do so post-launch. This involved tracking user workflow, compiling feedback from drivers, riders, and admins, and gathering evidence.
- Upheld campus safety by driving and accompanying students on campus during late hours.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Interactive Prelanding Experience *(JULY 2026)*

A marketing page built around an animated multi-state unlock mechanic. (React, Tailwind, custom animation)

"The Lone Stick" *(JANUARY 2026 - PRESENT)*

A narrative combat sidescroller stick-figure game currently in production where I am the primary level designer and co-wrote the narrative.

Procedural Game Audio *(JUNE 2026)*

Real-time audio systems in Pure Data with OSC integration to Unity, including a multi-voice NES synthesis engine.

SKILLS

Well-versed in:

- Figma
- Claude Design (AI)
- Phaser (JS)
- Git
- React
- TypeScript
- Tailwind
- Pure Data
- Unity
- Adobe Illustrator
- Adobe Photoshop

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz (UCSC) 2026

B.S. Computer Science: Game Design

B.A. Art: Games & Playable Media

Santa Teresa High School 2022

4-year Multimedia Pathway

ACTIVITIES + HONORS/AWARDS

Dean's Honor List

(Fall 2023)

Tennis - JV + Varsity

(2019 - 2022)

Volunteer Graphic Designer

(2020)